

Aravalli Mobility Pvt Ltd

SOP-SC-015: Approval Timeouts and Escalation

Owner: Head of Supply Chain Management · Version: 1.0 · Effective: 2026-10-03 · Supersedes: none · Applies to: every action record under SOP-SC-014 that contains RFQs.

Section 1 - Scope

1.1 This SOP defines how long each approver has to decide an action record that contains RFQs (SOP-SC-014 section 5), what happens when nobody decides, and who is told.

1.2 No RFQ document is released to a supplier until an approver at or above the SOP-SC-014 section 5 level has approved the action record.

Section 2 - Approval Windows and Escalation

2.1 The approval window starts when the action record is accepted. The window is 8 hours for an L2 action and 4 hours for an L3 action, the same as the response windows in SOP-SC-014 section 2.

2.2 When 50% of the window has passed without a decision, the current approver receives one reminder.

2.3 When the window ends without a decision, the action record escalates one level up the ladder: Operations Manager - Procurement, then Head of Supply Chain Management, then Chief Financial Officer. The new level receives the full window again.

2.4 Escalation never lowers authority. An approver at or above the SOP-SC-014 section 5 level for the total value may approve or reject at any time, including after escalation; an approver below that level may not.

Section 3 - When Nobody Decides

3.1 If the Chief Financial Officer level also ends its window without a decision, the action record is HELD. A held record releases nothing, and an alert goes to the Chief Financial Officer level.

3.2 There is no automatic approval and no bypass of an approver, whatever the amount. A held record stays held until an approver at or above the required level decides.

3.3 Every reminder, escalation, hold and decision is recorded with its time and actor, and kept for 7 years under SOP-SC-014 clause 6.3.

Section 4 - Production Planning

4.1 Production Planning is notified automatically when SOP-SC-014 clause 4.5 applies: projected stock-out within 7 days, or before the earliest backup supplier can deliver (clause 4.7). No person has to remember to send this notice.